SOURDOUGH CONCHA



YIELD	REST	OVEN	UNIT WEIGHT
14 conchas	**4-5 h levain, 5 h bulk, overnight to 2 days chilled, then 4-5 h final proof**	**350F / 177C, 18 min**	**about 85 g each**

ENERGY COST
$1.65 (18 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

50 g	Sourdough starter, for the levain
50 g	Bread flour, for the levain
50 g	Water, for the levain
570 g	Bread flour
62 g	Granulated sugar
11 g	Sea salt
3	Eggs
125 g	Whole milk, room temperature
1 tsp	Vanilla extract
113 g	Unsalted butter, softened
from 1 orange, optional	Orange zest
120 g	All-purpose flour, for the topping
113 g	Powdered sugar, sifted, for the topping
113 g	Unsalted butter, softened, for the topping
a pinch	Kosher salt, for the topping
as needed	Flavouring or colouring, for the topping

METHOD

1. Levain: stir starter, flour and water together, cover, and leave 4 to 5 hours at 75-80F until doubled and bubbly. Or skip it and use 150 g of active starter.
2. If using orange zest, rub it into the granulated sugar until it smells of orange and looks like wet sand.
3. Mix the flour, salt, sugar, eggs, milk, vanilla and all the levain until the flour is incorporated, a couple of minutes.
4. Cover and rest at least 10 minutes, so the flour hydrates fully.
5. Add the softened butter a tablespoon at a time, then mix about 10 minutes, until the dough is tacky but strong and passes the windowpane test.
6. Bulk ferment in a covered bowl at 75-80F for about 5 hours, until doubled, airy and domed.
7. Refrigerate overnight, up to 2 days.
8. Punch down, weigh the dough, divide by 14, and roll each portion into a ball. About 85 g each.
9. Topping: bring the flour, sifted powdered sugar, butter and salt together to a Play-Doh consistency. Divide and colour or flavour it now if you want more than one.
10. Press the topping into rounds and drape one over each ball.
11. Score the shell pattern with a lame, sharp knife or concha cutter.
12. Cover and proof 4 to 5 hours somewhere warm, until doubled, airy, and wobbling when you shake the tray.
13. Bake one tray at a time at 350F for 18 minutes, until lightly golden. Cool completely.

NOTES

Sourdough rather than commercial yeast, so the timeline runs across two days and the flavour is the point.
The topping is equal butter and powdered sugar at 113 g each against 120 g flour, which is why it stays pliable enough to drape and score.
Bulk at 75-80F. Cooler and the 5 hour figure stops applying.
Wobble when you shake the pan is the proof test, not the clock.
Divide the actual dough weight by 14 rather than trusting 85 g, since egg sizes vary.